Bacolod

Nearly 200,000 foreigners living in Philippines: census

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MANILA -- Foreigners living in the Philippines have reached to nearly 200,000, the National Statistics Office (NSO) said.

Based on the 2010 Census of Population and Housing (CPH), the number of foreign citizens in the country was 177,368 as of May 2010, the agency said.

The foreign population comprised 0.2 percent of the 92 million total household population, it said.

"The largest number of foreign citizens in the country came from the United States of America (29,959 persons). The next largest numbers came from China (28,750 persons), Japan (11,583 persons), and India (8,963 persons)," NSO said.

The census office said three in 10 foreign citizens (31.1 percent) were residing in National Capital Region (NCR) at the time of the census. Those residing in the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao made up 22.3 percent of the total foreign citizens. Central Luzon had 9.0 percent, Calabarzon had 8.4 percent, and Central Visayas had 6.0 percent of the total foreign citizens. Zamboanga Peninsula had the least proportion at 0.5 percent.

Included in the enumeration are citizens of foreign countries who have resided or are expected to reside in the Philippines for at least a year from their arrival, except members of diplomatic missions and non-Filipino members of international organizations and civilian citizens of foreign countries who have their usual residence in the Philippines, or foreign visitors who had stayed or are expected to stay for at least a year from the date of their arrival. **(SDR/Sunnex)**

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